

# **LFS Online Voting Platform: Developer Brief**

## **1. Purpose**

The platform will be used to conduct a secure and confidential LFS by-election during a virtual Extraordinary General Meeting (EGM).

## **2. User Roles**

The platform should support:

- Electoral Commission administrators;
- eligible voters;
- approved proxy holders; and
- read-only election observers, if authorised.

## **3. Voter Eligibility**

Only members appearing on the final voters' roll may vote. The Electoral Commission must be able to:

- upload or import the voters' roll;
- verify each member using a unique membership number, email address or phone number;
- mark members represented by proxy;
- prevent ineligible or duplicate voting; and
- export the final participation record.

## **4. Secret Ballot**

Voting must be by secret ballot. The platform must:

- separate voter authentication from the ballot cast;
- prevent administrators from seeing how an individual voted;
- allow each authorised ballot to be used only once;
- encrypt votes during submission and storage;
- prevent results from being viewed before polls close; and

- produce an auditable total without identifying individual voting choices.

## **5. Proxy Voting**

The platform should accommodate approved proxies as follows:

- proxy appointments must be verified before voting opens;
- one member may hold no more than five proxies;
- each approved proxy must generate a separate ballot entitlement;
- a member represented by proxy must not also vote directly;
- each proxy ballot must remain secret; and
- the audit record should show that the proxy entitlement was exercised, but not the candidate selected.

## **6. Ballot Requirements**

The ballot should:

- display the position being contested;
- show the names of all approved candidates;
- allow only one candidate to be selected;
- include an abstain option, if approved by the Electoral Commission;
- require confirmation before final submission; and
- prevent alteration after submission.

The Electoral Commission must be able to preview and approve the ballot at least 48 hours before the election.

## **7. Poll Management**

Authorised Electoral Commission members should be able to:

- set the opening and closing time;
- open and close voting;
- monitor turnout without seeing candidate totals;
- extend voting only through an authorised and recorded decision;
- receive reports of technical or electoral complaints; and
- lock the election permanently after closure.

## **8. Quorum and Attendance**

Meeting attendance must be recorded separately from voting. The system should show:

- members attending virtually;
- members represented by proxy;
- total members in good standing;
- whether the required 50% quorum has been achieved; and
- the time at which quorum was confirmed.

Being present at the EGM must not automatically record a vote.

## **9. Results**

After voting closes, the platform should:

- automatically count valid votes;
- display votes received by each candidate;
- show abstentions and rejected or incomplete ballots separately;
- identify the candidate with a simple majority;
- allow at least two Electoral Commission members to approve the result; and
- generate a downloadable election certificate and results report.

## **10. Audit and Security**

The system must maintain a tamper-resistant audit log showing:

- voter authentication;
- ballots issued and used;
- proxy ballots issued and used;
- failed login attempts;
- changes made by administrators;
- opening and closing times; and
- certification of results.

The audit log must never reveal how an individual voted. Administrators should use two-factor authentication, and all platform activity should occur over a secure encrypted connection.

## **11. Testing**

Before election day, the developer must provide:

- a complete test election;
- testing of direct and proxy voting;
- duplicate-vote prevention testing;
- mobile and desktop compatibility testing;
- a backup and recovery test; and

- a procedure for handling connectivity failures.

The Electoral Commission must approve the tested platform before the live election.